

6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577

Historical Farming, Agricultural Use and Land-Clearing Evidence Summary

Date: 30 April 2026 | Property reviewed: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577; Lot 4 DP746930.

Executive conclusion. Based on the material reviewed, the evidence supports the position that the subject land sits within the historic Bong Bong / Bulwer-Lytton Road locality, an area recorded in Austermere Estate material as cleared, ploughable and suitable for agricultural, dairy, orchard and farming use by 1904. The contract of sale provides the modern title and map bridge connecting 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4 DP746930 to that older locality.

Scope Reviewed

This summary reviews the exchanged contract of sale, the title search and plans inside that contract, the planning certificate, NSW Cadastre data queried for Lot 4 DP746930, the 1904 Austermere Estate sale material, State Library subdivision-plan references, and previously located historical sources. It focuses on evidence that may support prior farming, agricultural use, grazing, orchard/dairy use, or historical clearing of the land.

Key Findings

Finding	Evidence / source	Strength
The modern property is Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Contract page 43 title search: Folio 4/746930, Lot 4 in DP746930, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Strong for legal identity.
DP746930 was created by subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 in 1987.	Contract scanned plan page 44: DP746930, "Subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513", Moss Vale, Bong Bong, Camden.	Strong for parent-title bridge.
The land is in the Bulwer Road / Lytton Road area.	Contract plan page 44 shows Lytton Road and road-widening context. NSW Cadastre polygon for Lot 4 DP746930 places the parcel beside Bulwer Road and north of Lytton Road.	Strong for location.
Austermere Estate material records agricultural/farming suitability and clearing by 1904.	NLA 1904 Austermere Estate plan and catalogue record describe land as "large area cleared & ready for plough" and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms.	Strong for wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality; not yet direct title-chain proof for Lot 4.
The contract does not directly say Lot 4 itself was farmed.	Search/OCR of contract text, title search, scanned Gazette pages and annexures found title/easement/planning material but no direct phrase such as "Lot 4 was farmed" or "cleared for agriculture".	Important limitation.

Contract Review

The contract is useful mainly as a title and location document. It identifies the sale land as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale, part of Lot 4 DP746930, with a proposed unregistered subdivision. The prescribed documents include title search material, an unregistered plan, the current deposited plan, older easement/title documents, Crown purchase-related material, and the 2023 planning certificate.

Relevant contract references:

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 1	Identifies the property as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale; Lot 2 in an unregistered plan, part of Lot 4 DP746930; Part Folio Identifier 4/746930.	Confirms modern property identity.
Page 4	List of prescribed documents includes old system document and Crown purchase statement of account.	Shows deeper historical title material may exist beyond the bundle.

Historical Land Use Context

Historically and currently, the 6 Bulwer Road locality has transitioned from early colonial pastoral and farming country into a large rural-residential landholding, with later planning activity in the North-West Moss Vale area supporting low-density residential/environmental living outcomes.

Context finding. The broader Throsby/Bong Bong/Moss Vale landscape was historically pastoral and agricultural. The available title, parish, Austermere and aerial evidence supports the position that the subject land sits within a historically cleared and farmed rural landscape rather than an untouched native-land context.

1. Colonial Pastoral Use (1819 - late 1800s)

Throsby Park grant

Heritage NSW records Throsby Park as the surviving core of a 1,000-acre grant made to Dr Charles Throsby by Governor Macquarie in 1819. This places the wider Moss Vale/Bong Bong locality in an early colonial pastoral-estate context.

Clearing and farming context

The surrounding Southern Highlands landscape was progressively cleared and used for pastoral and agricultural purposes, including grazing and farming connected with early estates and later rural holdings.

Equine / exercise use

Given the proximity to Throsby Park and the later repeated oval/circular ground feature visible in aerial imagery, equine exercise or similar rural recreation use is a reasonable historical interpretation, although no commercial racecourse record for this exact lot has been identified in the material reviewed.

2. Rural, Hobby-Farming and Later Planning Context (20th century - 2010s)

Rural character

The modern parcel remained a large cleared landholding of about 8.6 hectares, consistent with a rural-residential or hobby-farming pattern rather than dense urban use.

Small-scale grazing / vacant rural land

The contract and aerial material indicate a mostly open land package with cleared paddock character, access tracks and rural ground features suitable for grazing, horse keeping or similar low-intensity agricultural use.

Residential/environmental living transition

Planning material for nearby North-West Moss Vale land, including 50A Bulwer Road, records rezoning from RU2 Rural Landscape to E4 Environmental Living with a 2-hectare minimum lot size. This supports the broader transition of comparable Bulwer Road land from rural landscape holdings toward large-lot residential/environmental living outcomes.

Sources noted for this context section

- Heritage NSW, Throsby Park Historic Site listing: 1,000-acre 1819 Throsby grant context.
- NSW Planning Portal / Wingecarribee material: 50A Bulwer Road RU2 Rural Landscape to E4 Environmental Living planning proposal.
- Report evidence: contract title/plan, parish maps, Austermere Estate material and NSW Spatial Services historical aerial imagery.

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing c
Page 43	Title search confirms Lot 4 DP746930 at Moss Vale, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Connects land to historical parish/county records.
Page 44	DP746930 plan shows subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered in 1987, with Lytton Road and surrounding road geometry.	Gives key parent-title step before the modern lot.
Pages 232-248	Planning certificate confirms current E4 General Industrial zoning and that agriculture/farm buildings are prohibited under current zoning.	Current zoning does not prove historic use.

Historical Farming / Clearing Evidence

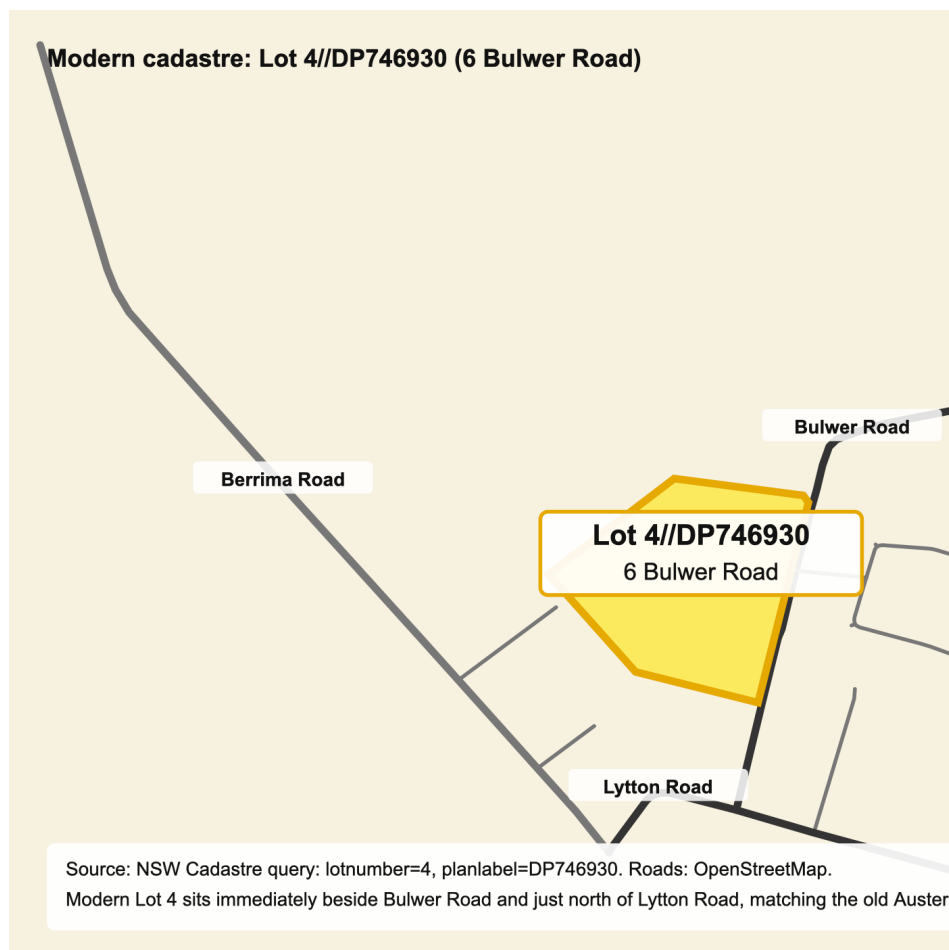
The best direct historical evidence remains the Austermere Estate sale material. The 1904 sale plan for Moss Vale Austermere Estate describes the estate as including a “large area cleared & ready for plough” and markets the land for residential sites, orchard blocks, dairy and agricultural farms. Separate NLA/State Library references also describe Austermere material as suitable for farming, dairying, grazing and market gardens. This supports a defensible “cleared by at least 1904” position for the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality.

Evidence Strength Matrix

Evidence item	What the evidence supports
Contract title search	Confirms the legal identity of the land as Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.
DP746930 plan	Shows modern Lot 4 was created from Lot 2 DP580513 and places the land around the Lytton/Bulwer Road area.
NSW Cadastre overlay	Places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road, aligning the modern parcel with the historical Bulwer/Lytton locality.
Austermere 1904 material	Records the historical Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farming by 1904.
Historical aerial imagery, next research step	Can add visual confirmation of open paddock/farmland character and later disturbance periods across the subject parcel and surrounding locality.

Visual Exhibit A: Modern Cadastre Overlay

NSW Cadastre data queried for lotnumber=4 and planlabel=DP746930 places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road.



Note: visual prepared from NSW Cadastre Feature Layer geometry and OpenStreetMap road geometry for orientation.

Source: Contract plan material for DP746930 / Lot 4.

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Austermere Estate 1904 - Original Listing Evidence

Source: National Library of Australia, Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904. NLA object nla.obj-230332818.

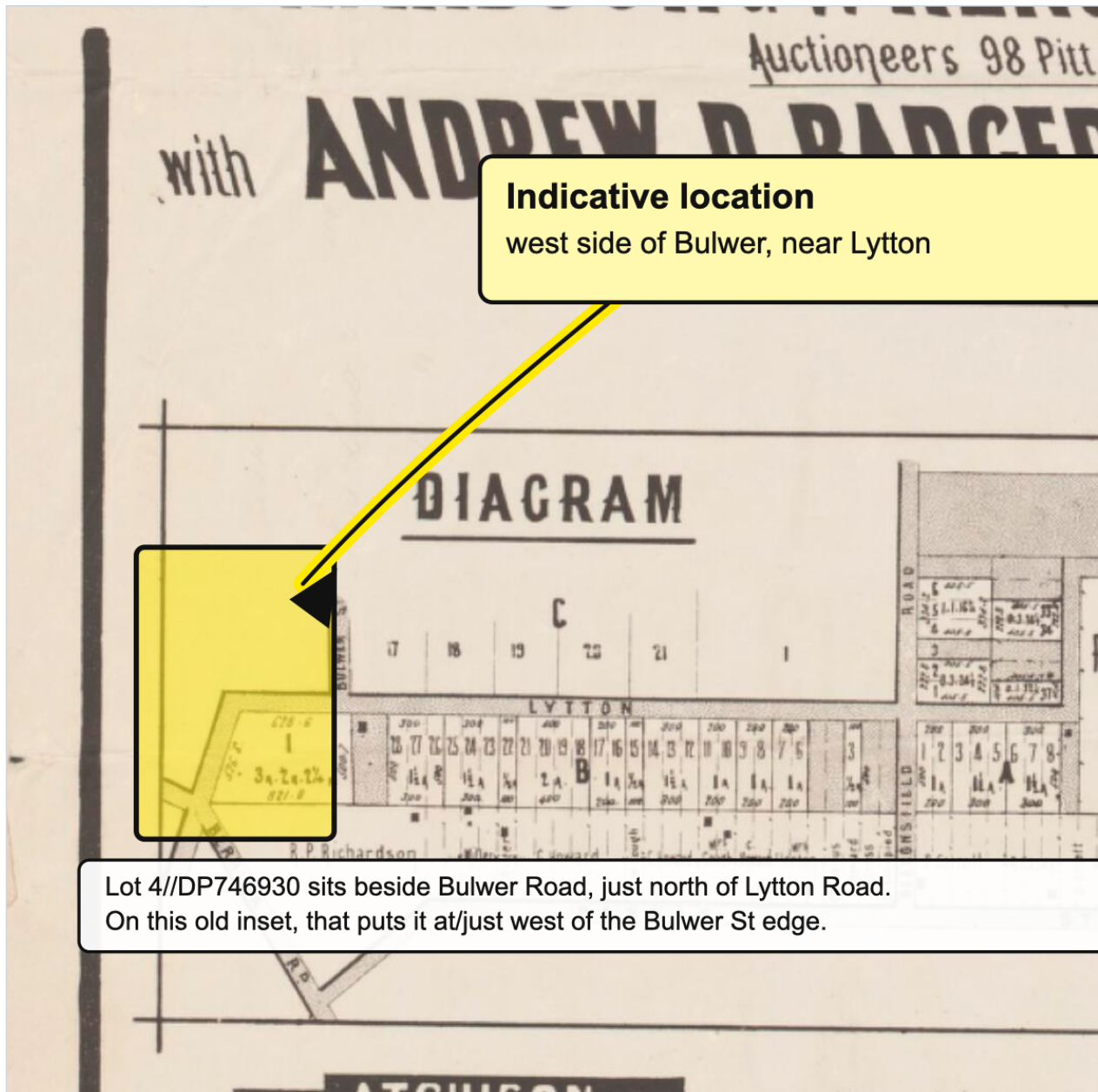
The full original 1904 Austermere Estate sale listing is shown vertically so the whole listing and plan can be viewed together. The material promotes 'Orchard Blocks, Dairy & Agricultural Farms' and records a 'large area cleared & ready for plough', supporting agricultural use, land clearing and farming suitability in the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality by 1904.



Visual Exhibit: Austermere Indicative Location

This exhibit reinstates the earlier Austermere map location view. It is an indicative visual guide only, showing the approximate Bulwer/Lytton locality relationship on the Austermere Estate material against the modern Lot 4 DP746930 location context.

Source: National Library of Australia Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904; indicative location annotation prepared from title/map comparison.



Sources Reviewed

- Exchanged Contract for Sale: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale.
- NSW LRS Title Search within contract, Folio 4/746930, search date 22 August 2023.
- DP746930 plan within contract, scanned page 44; subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered 1987.
- Wingecarribee Shire Council Planning Certificate S10.724/0403, dated 25 August 2023, within contract.
- NSW Cadastre ArcGIS Feature Layer queried for planlabel=DP746930 and lotnumber=4.
- National Library of Australia: Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904. <https://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-230332818/view>
- National Library of Australia catalogue records for Austermere Estate / Moss Vale promotional subdivision material.
- State Library NSW Moss Vale subdivision plans list. <https://content-lists.sl.nsw.gov.au/tabular-list/moss-vale-subdivision-plans>
- NSW Spatial Services Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

Summary Position

Based on the evidence reviewed, the land at 6 Bulwer Road is strongly associated with a locality historically used and promoted for farming and agricultural purposes. The modern title and deposited plan place the land in the Parish of Bong Bong and in the Bulwer/Lytton Road area. The Austermere Estate material for this same historical locality records land as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms by 1904. On that basis, the evidence supports the conclusion that the land formed part of a historically rural and agricultural landscape and that clearing for farming/agricultural use had occurred in the area by at least 1904.

Caveat

This report is an evidence summary prepared from available documents and public research material. It is not legal advice, a registered survey, a contamination assessment, or a formal historical land-use assessment. A solicitor, surveyor, environmental consultant or title search specialist should be engaged if the conclusions are to be used for legal, planning, financing or environmental due diligence purposes.

Parish Map and Crown Plan Review Addendum

This addendum reviews digitised Parish of Bong Bong maps and the contract title/plan material to help assess whether the 6 Bulwer Road locality was historically rural, agricultural, farmed or cleared for farming purposes.

Summary finding. The 1942 and 1968 Parish of Bong Bong maps support the view that the Bulwer/Lytton Road locality sat within a broader rural cadastral landscape made up of large acreages and named holdings. This adds support to the farming/agricultural history already shown in the 1904 Austermere material.

Map Sources Reviewed

Source	Relevant details	Relevance
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1942, 8th edition	Department of Lands parish map. NLA identifier nla.obj-233787591. Shows Moss Vale, Bong Bong parish, large rural holdings, road alignments and parish numbers.	Confirms rural parish portions and large acreages before modern industrial subdivision.
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, 9th edition	Department of Lands parish map. NLA identifier nla.obj-537799794. Cadastral map showing parish boundaries and land holdings.	Shows continuing rural/parish landholding context around Moss Vale and Bulwer/Lytton.
Contract DP746930 plan	Shows DP746930 was a subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 and places the modern parcel in the Lytton/Bulwer road area.	Provides modern-to-parent-plan bridge needed to compare with parish map location.

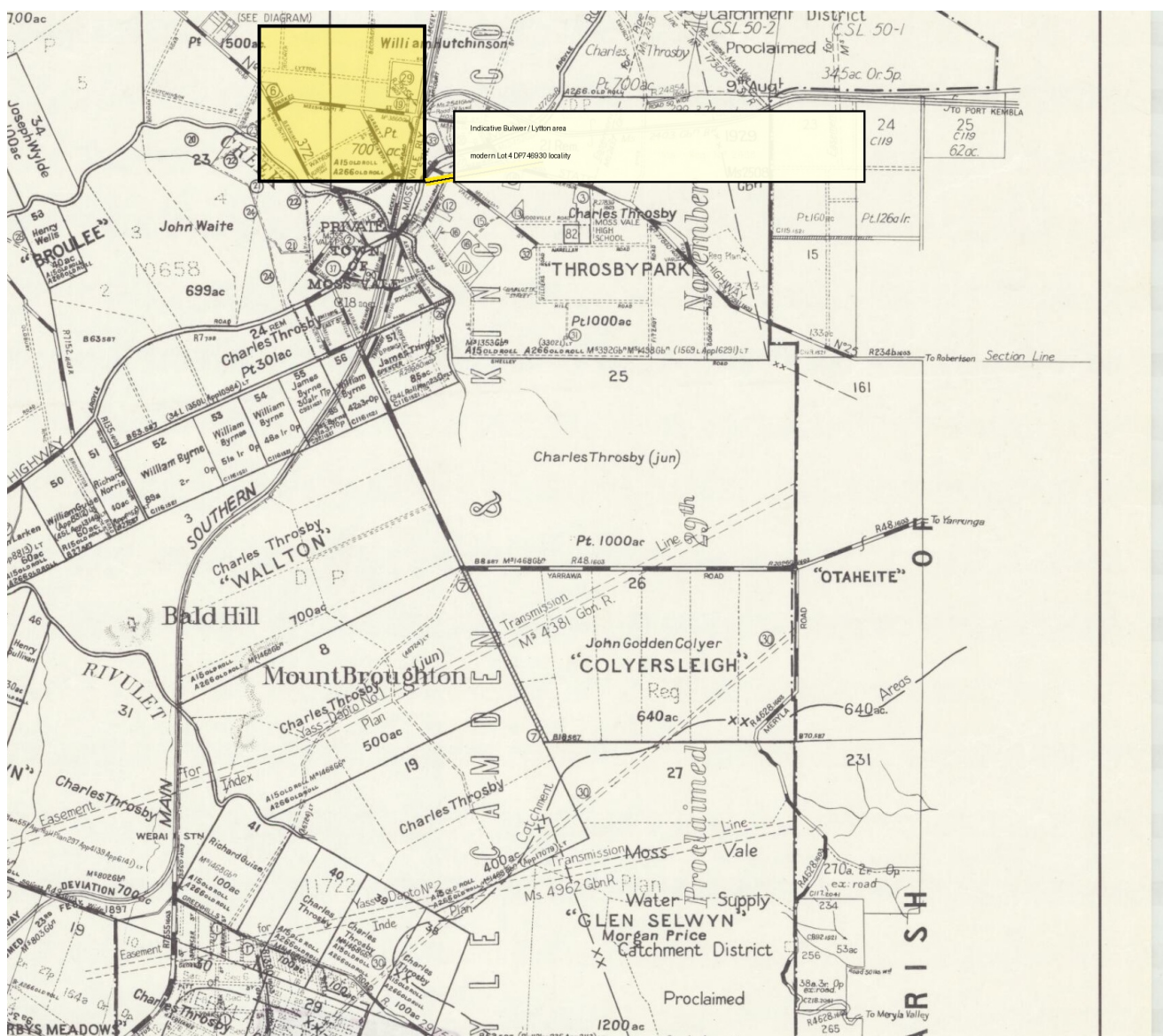
Parish Map Observations

- The maps show the Moss Vale locality in the context of older parish portions, old roll references and large acreage holdings, not as modern industrial land.
- Nearby holdings include William Hutchinson, John Waite, Charles Throsby, William Byrne and Throsby Park landholdings ranging from hundreds to around 1000 acres.
- The indicative Bulwer/Lytton position sits beside the older Moss Vale township and adjacent to large-acreage parish land, including a “Pt 700ac” area shown on the 1968 parish map.
- The parish-map review strengthens the historical farming/agricultural position by confirming the Bong Bong parish link, showing older rural landholding patterns, and aligning with the Austermere Estate evidence of cleared/ploughable agricultural land by 1904.

Addendum sources: NLA Parish of Bong Bong 1942 and 1968 maps; contract title search for Folio 4/746930; DP746930 plan extract.

Indicative Parish Map Extract

The highlighted area below is an indicative Bulwer/Lytton locality position on the 1968 Parish of Bong Bong map, used for orientation against the modern Lot 4 DP746930 location. It is not a surveyed overlay.



Source image: Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, Department of Lands, NLA object nla.obj-537799794; annotation prepared for this review.

Historical Aerials

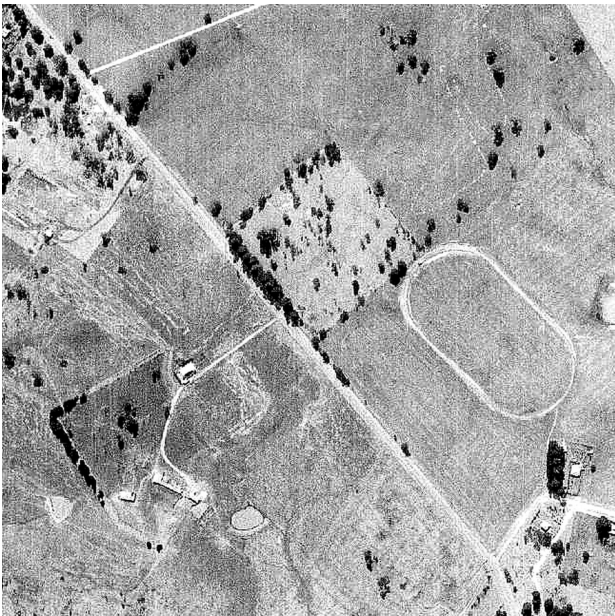
Source: NSW Spatial Services - Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

The aerial extracts below are ordered from earliest to latest. The views are tighter, oval-focused clean extracts with no survey-style pinpoint markers shown.

Historical aerial imagery sourced from NSW Spatial Services shows repeated cleared paddock areas, access tracks and an oval/circular ground feature near 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4 DP746930. The repeated appearance across multiple years is useful visual evidence that the land had been cleared, shaped, accessed, maintained and disturbed, rather than remaining untouched or uncleared native land.

Corrected view: 19/08/1963 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 29/12/1974 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



1963 and 1974 tighter oval-focused aerial extracts. No pinpoint marker is shown.

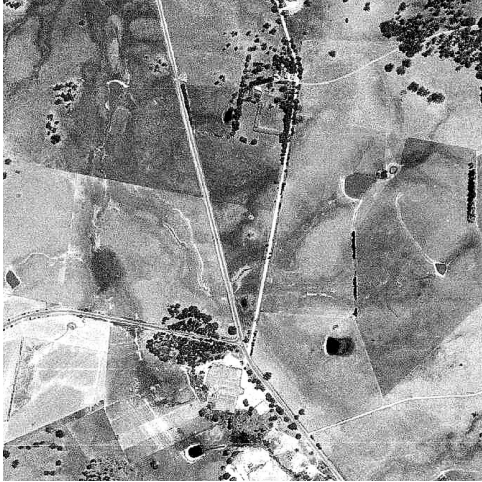
Historical Aerials

Source: NSW Spatial Services - Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

1979, 1989, 1991 and 1997 tighter oval-focused clean aerial extracts, ordered earliest to latest.

Corrected view: 08/01/1979 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 25/02/1989 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 23/09/1991 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 24/09/1991 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 21/01/1997 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Final image retained on the same page and zoomed in to match the rest of the aerial set.